

My Inner Critic vs. My Inner Coach

DURATION	35–40 min · Week 4
OBJECTIVE	Students identify the inner critic voice, contrast it with the inner coach, and practice reframing one critical thought.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness · Self-Management: self-talk and reframing
VOCABULARY	inner critic, inner coach, self-talk, reframe, voice
MATERIALS	Journals · WS3 Two Voices · Anchor chart · Scenario cards

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

“Who made a mistake this week?” (Most hands.) “Who was hard on themselves about it?” “Today we meet the voice that turns a mistake into a flaw statement. It has a name.”

1

Introduce the Inner Critic

2–10 MIN

Do you have a voice that makes things about who you ARE, not just what you did? Examples: “You always mess up.” / “You’re not as good as everyone else.” Pattern: the inner critic ATTACKS identity. It is global. It catastrophizes.

2

Introduce the Inner Coach

10–17 MIN

The inner coach is honest AND kind. Three questions: WHAT happened? WHAT can I learn? WHAT is one next step? Post these permanently.

ANCHOR CHART · INNER CRITIC VS. INNER COACH — PERMANENT ANCHOR CHART

Build WITH students — both columns. Color-code: red for Critic, green for Coach. Post permanently. Students will use this language spontaneously by Week 8.

3

Build the Anchor Chart

17–22 MIN

Two columns: INNER CRITIC language / INNER COACH language. Students help generate both sides.

4

Scenario Card Reframes (WS3)

22–32 MIN

Distribute WS3. For each scenario: (1) Write what the inner critic says. (2) Write what the inner coach says. (3) Which helps them do better next time? Debrief: “Was the coach softer? Did it ignore what happened?” [No — honest AND kind.]